

STEVE CUMMINS

Principal / Chief Marketer, Solent Strategies

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WHEN	FORMAT	LENGTH
SESSION 7 FRI, SEPT 25 • 12:30 PM ET	PRESENTATION* WITH SLIDES, THEN Q&A	30 MINUTES VIRTUAL

YOUR TITLE

Marketing that Maps the Customer Journey

OUR SUGGESTION

Yours is good. We would publish it exactly as written.

DEFAULT EVENT COPY

This is what we will publish on the event page.
If you would like it adjusted, send us the revisions.

ABOUT THIS SESSION

Every founder is told to do marketing, and everyone they ask has a different opinion. Steve Cummins, a fractional CMO with more than 20 years in B2B marketing, walks the customer journey stage by stage, shows which tactics belong where, and closes on the one or two things worth doing well.

WHAT YOU WILL LEAVE WITH

- Define the goal of your marketing, then match tactics to each stage
- What has to be in place before you spend: a clear message, a defined reachable audience
- Do one or two things well rather than covering every base

WHO IT IS FOR

Founders who are pre-revenue and testing the market, already generating revenue, or raising. Useful to anyone who knows they should be marketing and has neither the time nor the budget to do all of it.

ABOUT STEVE

Steve helps growing businesses punch above their weight, working with companies who are ready to take marketing seriously but are not ready for a full time CMO. That means developing the right message, reaching a broader audience, and executing a marketing plan tailored for their business. Steve has an engineering background and more than 20 years experience in global B2B marketing with name-brand companies and feisty start-ups. He also coaches and mentors marketers and teams of one.

FROM THEIR APPLICATION

WHO THEY SAID IT SPEAKS TO

Pre-revenue and testing the market • Already generating revenue • Raising, or about to

WHAT THEY SAID THEY WOULD COVER

Takes the original marketing funnel approach and shows how different tactics are used at different stages, and how that now needs a more nuanced approach as the customer journey has become less linear.

WHY THEY THINK IT MATTERS NOW

Everyone knows they should be doing marketing and everyone they talk to has an opinion on what it looks like. Every founder has no spare time and a small budget, so it matters where those go.

BRINGS FOR THE RESOURCE LIBRARY

A one-pager built for this session, plus an 8-page eBook, Building a Realistic Marketing Strategy.

WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

Your 30 minutes

Roughly 20 minutes of content, then questions. We hold the clock.

Sync call

15 minutes with us the week before. We send the invite.

Calendar hold

For the session itself. Lands in your inbox as soon as you confirm the date.

**Slides only. If you are presenting, the final deck is due 72 hours before the session.*

ERIC SCHMALZBAUER

Former co-founder & CEO, Prospective

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WHEN	FORMAT	LENGTH
SESSION 2 MON, SEPT 14 • 12:30 PM ET	FIRESIDE CHAT WE INTERVIEW, FOUNDERS ASK	30 MINUTES VIRTUAL

YOUR TITLE

B2B: from idea > funding > failure

OUR SUGGESTION

Yours is good. We would publish it exactly as written.

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ABOUT THIS SESSION

Founders hear success stories constantly and almost never a first-hand account of the other outcome. Eric Schmalzbauer walks the whole arc of his venture-backed B2B startup: idea, fundraising, team building, and the decision to wind it down. Candid conversation, not a polished talk.

WHAT YOU WILL LEAVE WITH

- Tangible examples of what worked and what did not inside a venture-backed startup
- As a founder you always have to be selling, in some form
- Honest acknowledgement that the job is very lonely

WHO IT IS FOR

Any founder in the cohort. The worries overlap whatever the stage: fundraising, team building, go-to-market, managing investors.

ABOUT ERIC

Eric Schmalzbauer is a technology executive, founder, and venture partner across product strategy, data platforms, and go-to-market execution. He is the now former co-Founder and CEO of Prospective, the team behind the open-source Perspective project, building high-performance tools for interactive data analytics. Eric previously held senior leadership roles across financial market infrastructure and enterprise technology. As a Venture Partner at REFASHIOND Ventures, he advises early-stage founders on product-market fit, fundraising, and scaling.

FROM THEIR APPLICATION

WHO THEY SAID IT SPEAKS TO

Any founder in the cohort

WHAT THEY SAID THEY WOULD COVER

His experience as a first-time founder: idea, fundraising, team building, and when and why to close up shop. Then what he will change for his next business, and what he will do more of.

BRINGS FOR THE RESOURCE LIBRARY

Workbench Ventures GTM Weekly newsletter.

WHY THEY THINK IT MATTERS NOW

Whatever the stage or maturity of the company, the cross-section of worries is the same: fundraising, team building, go-to-market, investor management.

WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

Your 30 minutes	A 30 minute conversation, questions from founders throughout. We hold the clock.
Sync call	15 minutes with us the week before. We send the invite.
Calendar hold	For the session itself. Lands in your inbox as soon as you confirm the date.

JULIA KAHKY

VP Operations, Tailsight

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WHEN

SESSION 5
MON, SEPT 21 • 12:30 PM ET

FORMAT

PRESENTATION*
WITH SLIDES, THEN Q&A

LENGTH

30 MINUTES
VIRTUAL

YOUR TITLE

From startup to dissolution: a post-mortem

OUR SUGGESTION

Yours is good. One option: add the subtitle **Selling into enterprise and regulated markets**, so it reads distinctly beside another founder post-mortem in the same series. Entirely your call.

DEFAULT EVENT COPY

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ABOUT THIS SESSION

Everything online is about how companies succeed. Julia Kahky walks the post-mortem of a startup that closed, specifically what she learned selling software to enterprise and highly regulated customers: the problems worth avoiding early, product-market fit, and how long sales cycles really take.

WHAT YOU WILL LEAVE WITH

- Problems to avoid early on
- Product-market fit
- Sales cycles

WHO IT IS FOR

Founders at any stage, from idea through raising, and anyone selling into enterprise or regulated buyers where cycles are long and requirements arrive late.

ABOUT JULIA

Julia Kahky is VP of Operations at a software company in the aviation industry, with prior experience as a chief of staff and in financial technology and operations in sports media. She started her career in finance and has worked across Fortune 15 companies, 500-person companies, and startups, with experience spanning finance, operations, marketing, revenue operations, and HR.

FROM THEIR APPLICATION

WHO THEY SAID IT SPEAKS TO

Every option selected: any founder in the cohort, idea stage, MVP or early build, pre-revenue, generating revenue, raising, and founders who want to understand investors

WHAT THEY SAID THEY WOULD COVER

Everything learned trying to sell software to enterprise customers and highly regulated markets. What works and what does not.

WHY THEY THINK IT MATTERS NOW

Everything online talks about how companies succeed, when people learn far more from avoiding the mistakes of companies that failed.

BRINGS FOR THE RESOURCE LIBRARY

Her community, The Atrium. The post-mortem deck. A list of AI tools, tips and tricks.

WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

Your 30 minutes

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